

ACTIVITY 11 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**Affinity Diagram and Kano Analysis**

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE	MAPS TO
Elective Lab	45 min	DEFINE	K2

Purpose of this activity

Organise customer requirements and classify them by satisfaction impact (K2).

Two Define-phase tools from the original course. Use an Affinity Diagram to cluster unstructured VOC input into themes, then apply Kano Analysis to classify requirements as Must-Be, One-Dimensional or Delighter.

What learners produce

An Affinity Diagram of named VOC clusters and a Kano classification table identifying where to invest first.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- A laptop with Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc
- The CSV files in this activity's data/ and templates/ folders
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and the framework

Set-up

Groups of 3-5. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. Every activity runs on the same continuous Contoso Service Desk scenario, so remind learners where this one sits in that story before starting.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder

data/ — the mock data you analyse:

- voice-of-customer.csv — 10 rows (id, customer_statement, source, date)

templates/ — the worksheets you complete:

- affinity-groups.csv (voc_id, statement, affinity_group)
- kano-classification.csv (requirement, kano_class_MustBe_OneDim_Delighter, why, invest_first)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Write each VOC statement on a separate note — one idea per note.	Silent clustering is not optional — talking lets the loudest voice anchor the groups.
2	Cluster related notes into natural groups without talking, then name each group.	Must-Be requirements are invisible when met and fatal when missed; test with an example.
3	Classify each requirement as Must-Be, One-Dimensional or Delighter.	
4	Plot the requirements on the Kano diagram and identify where to invest first.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
10 min	Write each VOC statement on its own note
15 min	Cluster silently into groups
10 min	Name each affinity group
10 min	Classify against Kano and plot

Total: 45 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Which requirement is a Must-Be that nobody would ever praise you for meeting?
2. Where would investment produce the most satisfaction per unit of effort?
3. Did silent clustering change the grouping versus discussing it?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what the data showed.
- Link the activity explicitly back to the DEFINE phase of DMAIC.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- What Delighter could you add to your own service at almost no cost?
- Which Must-Be is your team currently failing?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- Silent clustering is not optional — talking lets the loudest voice anchor the groups.
- Must-Be requirements are invisible when met and fatal when missed; test with an example.

Success criterion

Every VOC note sits in exactly one named affinity group and carries a Kano classification.

Assessment link

This activity builds the DEFINE phase of DMAIC. All activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS), which reuses the same techniques on the same Contoso Service Desk scenario and the same figures (400 tickets, yield 76%, DPMO 50,000). Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.